

Unit 1



Living in the Present

Inglés Profesional

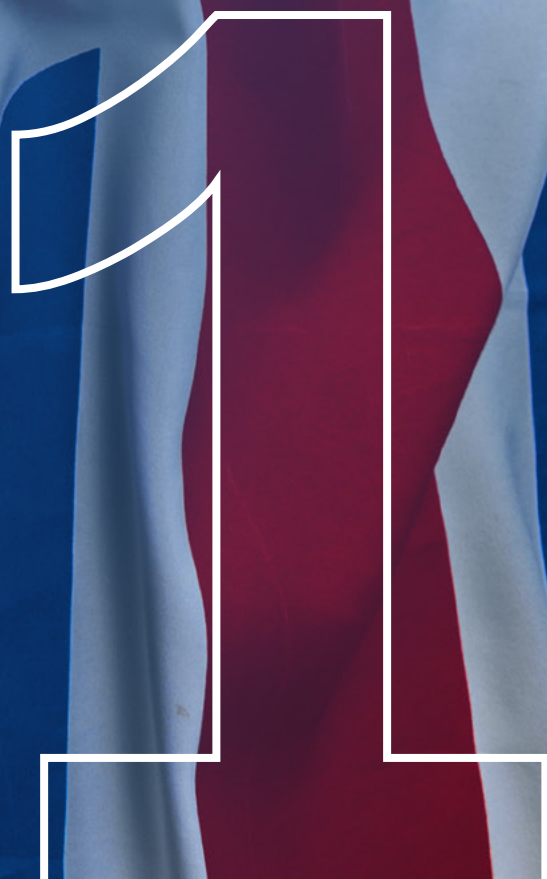




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Introduction

In this unit, we will start with the basics to build a strong foundation in English. First, we will study the verb **to be** and the verb **to have got** in the present tense, looking at their structure, uses, and special rules. Then, we will learn about the **present simple**, focusing on how to form it, when to use it, and the **adverbs of frequency** that go with it. After that, we will move on to the **present continuous**, examining its structure, key uses, and the rules for forming **-ing verbs**, including spelling changes. To finish the unit, we will talk about the **stative verbs** and compare the **present simple** and the **present continuous**, explaining their differences and when to use each one in different situations.



1.1.

The verb "To Be"

1.1.1. Definition and Uses

The verb **to be** is one of the most important verbs in English. It is used to:

- > Describe people, things, weather or situations
 - » Example: She **is** a teacher.
- > Give information about age, nationality, profession, etc.
 - » Example: I **am** Spanish. / He **is** 25 years old.
- > Talk about locations
 - » Example: They **are** at home.
- > Talk about feelings and states
 - » Example: We **are** happy today.
- > Form continuous tenses (See present continuous)
 - » Example: She **is** studying English.

1.1.2. Forms of "To Be" in the Present Tense

The verb **to be** is irregular, meaning it **does not follow the regular rules** of other verbs.

Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
I am	I am not	Am I?
You are	You are not	Are you?
He is	He is not	Is he?
She is	She is not	Is she?
It is	It is not	Is it?
We are	We are not	Are we?
You are	You are not	Are you?
They are	They are not	Are they?





Additionally, in spoken and informal written English, **to be** is often contracted.

Contractions (Short Form)

Affirmative	Short Form	Negative	Short Form
I am	I'm	I am not	I'm not
You are	You're	You are not	You're not / You aren't
He is	He's	He is not	He's not / He isn't
She is	She's	She is not	She's not / She isn't
It is	It's	It is not	It's not / It isn't
We are	We're	We are not	We're not / We aren't
You are	You're	You are not	You're not / You aren't
They are	They're	They are not	They're not / They aren't

Examples:

- » I **am** a student. (= I'm a student.)
- » You **are** my friend. (= You're my friend.)
- » She **is not** a doctor. (= She **isn't** a doctor.)
- » We **are not** in the park. (= We **aren't** in the park.)
- » **Are** they happy?
- » **Is** he at school?

Short answers

Short answers must include the verb **to be** instead of just "yes" or "no."

Question	Affirmative Answer	Negative Answer
Are you a student?	Yes, I am.	No, I'm not.
Is he your brother?	Yes, he is.	No, he isn't.
Are they at school?	Yes, they are.	No, they aren't.

1.1.3. Summary Table

Sentence Type	Structure	Example
Affirmative	Subject + am/is/are	"She is a teacher."
Negative	Subject + am/is/are + not	"She is not a teacher."
Question	Am/Is/Are + subject?	"Is she a teacher?"
Short Answer	Yes/No + subject + am/is/are (+ not)	"Yes, she is." / "No, she isn't."



1.2.

"To Have Got" vs. "To Have"

1.2.1. Meaning and Uses

Both **have got** and **have** are used to express:

- > **Possession (something you own)**
 - » Example:
"I **have got** a new phone" or "I **have** a new phone"
- > **Relationships (family, friends, etc.)**
 - » Example:
"She **has got** two brothers" or "She **has** two brothers."
- > **Physical Appearance**
 - » Example: "He **has got** blue eyes" or "He **has** blue eyes."
- > **Illnesses or Conditions**
 - » Example:
"They **have got** a headache" or "They **have** a headache"

BUT

- > **Have got** is more common in **British English**.
- > **Have** is used in both **American** and **British English**.

So, in the **UK**, people often say "**I've got a car**", but in the **US**, people usually say "**I have a car**".

1.2.2. Forms of "To Have Got" and "To Have" in the Present Tense

Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
I have got / I have	I haven't got / I don't have	Have I got...? / Do I have...?
You have got / You have	You haven't got / You don't have	Have you got...? / Do you have...?
He has got / He has	He hasn't got / He doesn't have	Has he got...? / Does he have...?
She has got / She has	She hasn't got / She doesn't have	Has she got...? / Does she have...?
It has got / It has	It hasn't got / It doesn't have	Has it got...? / Does it have...?
We have got / We have	We haven't got / We don't have	Have we got...? / Do we have...?
You have got / You have	You haven't got / You don't have	Have you got...? / Do you have...?
They have got / They have	They haven't got / They don't have	Have they got...? / Do they have...?



Contractions (Short Form)

Have Got	Have
Have got / has got = 've got / 's got	Have / has = no contraction
Have not got / has not got = haven't got / hasn't got	Do not / does not = don't / doesn't

> Examples:

- » I **have got** a pet. (= I've got a pet.)
- » She **has got** two brothers. (= She's got two brothers.)
- » They **have not got** a big house. (= They **haven't got** a big house.)
- » He **has not got** a car. (= He **hasn't got** a car.)
- » You **have** green eyes. (✗ You've green eyes.)
- » The dog **does not have** a tail. (= The dog **doesn't have** a tail.)

Short answers

> Examples:

- » **Have** you **got** a car? → **Yes, I have.** / **No, I haven't.**
- » **Has** she **got** a brother? → **Yes, she has.** / **No, she hasn't.**
- » **Do** they **have** a child? → **Yes, they do.** / **No, they don't.**
- » **Does** he **have** a motorbike? → **Yes, he does.** / **No, he doesn't.**

1.2.3. When NOT to Use "Have got"

Have got is only used in the **present**.

You **CANNOT** use "**have got**" in **past**, **future**, or **continuous tenses**.

- > ✓ **I had a bike when I was a child.** (Correct)
(See the past in Unit 3)
- > ✗ I had got a bike when I was a child. (Wrong)
- > ✓ **She will have a big house in the future.** (Correct)
(See the future in Unit 4)
- > ✗ She will have got a big house in the future. (Wrong)
- > ✓ **He is having lunch.** (Correct)
(See the present continuous below)
- > ✗ He is having got lunch. (Wrong)



1.2.4. Summary Table

Sentence Type	"Have Got" / "Have"
Affirmative	I have got a car / I have a car
Negative	I haven't got a car / I don't have a car
Interrogative	Have you got a car? / Do you have a car?
Short Answer	Yes, I have / No, I haven't / Yes, I do / No, I don't



RECUERDA

"Have got" solo se utiliza en inglés británico.

Este verbo solo se usa en presente simple.

Para los demás tiempos verbales (presente continuo, pasado, futuro) usamos el "have", que funciona como cualquier otro verbo.





1.3.

Present Simple

1.3.1. Definition and Uses

The **Present Simple** is a verb tense used to describe:

- > **Habits and Routines** → Actions that happen regularly
» Example: "I **wake up** at 7 AM every day."
- > **General Truths and Facts** → Things that are always true.
» Example: "Water **boils** at 100°C."
- > **Permanent Situations** → Things that do not change over time.
» Example: "She **lives** in Madrid."
- > **Scheduled Events (Timetables)** → Used for fixed events in the future. (See 'The future' in Unit 4)
» Example: "The train **leaves** at 8 PM."
- > **Feelings and Opinions** → Used with stative verbs (like, love, believe, know, etc.).
» Example: "I **like** chocolate."

1.3.2. How to Form the Present Simple

Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
I work	I don't work	Do I work?
You work	You don't work	Do you work?
He works	He doesn't work	Does he work?
She works	She doesn't work	Does she work?
It works	It doesn't work	Does it work?
We work	We don't work	Do we work?
You work	You don't work	Do you work?
They work	They don't work	Do they work?

> Examples:

- » I **play** football every weekend.
- » She **plays** tennis on Saturdays.
- » He **watches** football at the weekend.
- » You **don't like** coffee
- » They **don't go** to the gym.
- » **Do you like** pizza?
- » **Does she speak** English?

> Short Answers:

- » **Do you like** coffee? → ✓ **Yes, I do.** / ✗ Yes, I like.
- » **Does she play** football? → ✓ **No, she doesn't.**

💡 RECUERDA

En las oraciones negativas e interrogativas, el verbo principal permanece en su forma base:

- + ✗ He doesn't works.
- + ✓ He doesn't work.

- + ✗ Does she speaks English?
- + ✓ Does she speak English?

"Do not" se puede contraer como "don't" y "does not" como "doesn't."



1.3.3. Spelling Rules for Third-Person Singular (He/She/It)

- > We add **-s** to most verbs:
 - » "He **works** in a bank." / "It **rains** a lot in the UK."
- > We add **-es** to verbs ending in **-ch, -sh, -x, -ss, -o**:
 - » "She **watches** TV." / "He **goes** to school."
- > We add **-s** to verbs ending in **vowel + y**:
 - » "Jane **plays** the piano"
- > With verbs ending in a **consonant + y**, we change **y** to **i** and add **-es**:
 - » "Charles **studies** English." / "Anne **tries** her best."



RECUERDA

- + En la mayoría de los verbos, añadimos **-s**:
 - > get → gets / like → likes / see → sees
- + En los verbos terminados en **-ch, -sh, -x, -ss, -o**, añadimos **-es**:
 - > watch → watches / go → goes / smash → smashes
- + En los verbos terminados en vocal + **y**, añadimos **-s**:
 - > play → plays / say → says / enjoy → enjoys
- + En los verbos que terminan en consonante + **y**, cambiamos la **"y"** por **"i"** y añadimos **-es**:
 - > study → studies / cry → cries / try → tries

1.3.4. Adverbs of frequency

Adverbs of frequency tell **how often** something happens.

A- Common Adverbs of Frequency (from most to least frequent)

Adverb	Meaning	Example
Always	Siempre	"She always arrives early."
Often	A menudo	"He often goes to the gym."
Frequently	Frecuentemente	"She frequently travels for work."
Usually	Usualmente	"I usually drink coffee in the morning."
Generally	Generalmente	"People generally prefer warm weather over cold."
Normally	Normalmente	"I normally wake up at 7 a.m."
Sometimes	A veces	"We sometimes watch movies at night."
Rarely	Raramente	"They rarely eat fast food."
Hardly ever	Casi nunca	"We hardly ever drink alcohol."
Never	Nunca	"I never smoke."



B- Word Order: Where to Place the Adverb?

1. Before the main verb

- ✓ I **always** eat breakfast.
- ✓ She **never** watches TV.
- ✗ I study **always** in the evening.

2. After the verb 'to be'

- ✓ He is **always** late.
- ✓ They are **never** tired.
- ✗ He **usually** is late.

3. Between an auxiliary verb and a main verb

- ✓ I don't **usually** eat sweets.
- ✓ They don't **always** arrive on time.
- ✗ I **usually** don't eat sweets.

C- Exceptions and Special Cases

1. "Sometimes" and "Usually" can also go at the beginning or end of a sentence:

- ✓ **Sometimes**, I go for a walk.
- ✓ I go for a walk **sometimes**.

2. "Never" is already negative, so don't use "don't" or "doesn't" with it:

- ✓ He **never** eats meat.
- ✗ He doesn't **never** eat meat. (Incorrect!)

D. Adverbs of Frequency with "Very" and Other Modifiers

When **adverbs of frequency** are modified by words like "**very**" or "**too**", they can go at the **end of the sentence**.

- ✓ She doesn't eat sweets **very often**.
- ✓ He goes to the gym **too rarely**.
- ✓ We visit our grandparents **quite frequently**.

RECUERDA

Los adverbios de frecuencia se colocan delante del verbo principal, después del verbo 'to be' o entre un auxiliar y un verbo principal:

- + ✗ I eat always fruits
- + ✓ I always eat fruits
- + ✗ He always is late
- + ✓ He is always late
- + ✗ He usually doesn't drink coffee
- + ✓ He doesn't usually drink coffee.

Algunos adverbios de frecuencia como "sometimes" y "usually" pueden ir también al principio o al final de la oración.

Cuando los adverbios de frecuencia van acompañados de palabras como 'very' o 'too', pueden ir al final de la oración.

1.3.5. Summary Table

Sentence Type	Structure	Example
Affirmative	Subject + base verb (+s/es for he/she/it)	"She plays football."
Negative	Subject + do/does + not + base verb	"He doesn't like coffee."
Interrogative	Do/Does + subject + base verb?	"Do you study English?"
With adverbs	Adverb + verb OR to be + adverb	"They often go to the park." / "He is always late."



1.4.

Present Continuous

1.4.1. Meaning and Uses

The **Present Continuous** tense is used to describe actions that are happening **right now** or around the **current time**, or to talk about **future plans**. Common adverbs used with this tense are **now**, **at the moment**, **currently**, **today**, **this week**, etc.

Uses

- > **Actions happening at the moment of speaking**
 - » *Example:* She **is reading** a book **right now**.
- > **Temporary actions** (things happening around the present, but not necessarily at the exact moment of speaking)
 - » *Example:* I **am studying** English **this year**.
- > **Future arrangements or plans** (fixed plans for the near future) (*See 'The future' in Unit 4*)
 - » *Example:* We **are meeting** them **tomorrow**.

1.4.2. How to Form the Present Continuous

Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
I am studying	I am not studying	Am I studying?
You are studying	You aren't studying	Are you studying?
He is studying	He isn't studying	Is he studying?
She is studying	She isn't studying	Is she studying?
It is studying	It isn't studying	Is it studying?
We are studying	We aren't studying	Are we studying?
You are studying	You aren't studying	Are you studying?
They are studying	They aren't studying	Are they studying?

Examples:

- > I **am eating** lunch.
- > She **is watching** TV.
- > They **aren't playing** football.
- > You **aren't swimming** right now.
- > **Are you studying** English.
- > **Is she dancing**?

Short Answers

- > "Is he **working** today?" → **Yes, he is.** / **No, he isn't.**
- > "Are they **going** to the party tonight?" → **Yes, they are.** / **No, they aren't.**



1.4.3. Spelling Rules for Verbs with -ing

When forming the **Present Continuous**, you add **"-ing"** to the verb. However, there are a few rules to follow:

1. **Verbs ending in -e:** Remove the **-e** and add **-ing**:
 - » *Make* → **Making**
 - » *Dance* → **Dancing**
 - » *Write* → **Writing**
2. **Verbs ending in a single consonant after a vowel:**
Double the consonant and add **-ing**:
 - » *Run* → **Running**
 - » *Sit* → **Sitting**
 - » *Swim* → **Swimming**
3. **Verbs ending in -ie:** Change **-ie** to **-y** and add **-ing**:
 - » *Die* → **Dying**
 - » *Lie* → **Lying**

1.4.4. Summary Table

Sentence Type	Structure	Example
Affirmative	Subject + am/are/is + verb-ing	"He is playing."
Negative	Subject + am/are/is + not + verb-ing	"He is not playing."
Interrogative	Am/are/is + subject + verb-ing?	"Is he playing?"
Short Answer	Yes/No + subject + am/is/are (+not)	"Yes, he is." / "No, he is not."

💡 RECUERDA

El Presente Continuo se usa para **acciones que están ocurriendo ahora o alrededor del presente.**

NO se usa para acciones habituales (para eso se usa el Presente Simple).

Algunos adverbios comunes con este tiempo verbal: now (ahora), at the moment (en este momento), currently (actualmente), today (hoy), this week (esta semana), etc.





1.5.

Present Simple and Present Continuous

1.5.1. Stative verbs

Stative verbs are verbs that describe **states, not actions**. They usually refer to **emotions, thoughts, possession, the senses, and relationships**. These verbs are **NOT** normally used in the **Present Continuous** because they describe something that is not changing or in progress.

Types of Stative Verbs

1. Verbs of emotion and feeling

» like, love, hate, prefer, need, want

- + ✓ I **like** pizza.
- + ✗ *I am liking pizza.*
- + ✓ She **wants** a new phone.
- + ✗ *She is wanting a new phone.*

2. Verbs of thinking and opinion

» believe, think, know, understand, remember, forget

- + ✓ I **believe** in ghosts.
- + ✗ *I am believing in ghosts.*
- + ✓ I **know** the answer.
- + ✗ *I am knowing the answer.*

3. Verbs of senses (how something seems or feels)

» see, hear, smell, taste, feel, look

- + ✓ This cake **tastes** delicious.
- + ✗ *This cake is tasting delicious.*
- + ✓ I **hear** music.
- + ✗ *I am hearing music.*

4. Verbs of possession and being

» have, own, belong, be

- + ✓ He **has** a big house.
- + ✗ *He is having a big house.*
- + ✓ This book **belongs** to me.
- + ✗ *This book is belonging to me.*



Exceptions

Some verbs can be **stative** or **action verbs**, depending on the meaning:

> Think

- » ✓ I **think** this is a good idea. (= I **believe** → **stative**)
- » ✓ I **am thinking** about my future. (= I **am considering** → **action**)

> See

- » ✓ I **see** a bird. (= I **notice it** → **stative**)
- » ✓ I **am seeing** my friends later. (= I **am meeting them** → **action**) (See the Future in Unit 4)

> Have

- » ✓ I **have** a car. (= **possession** → **stative**)
- » ✓ I **am having** lunch. (= **eating** → **action**)

1.5.2. Comparative table between the Present Simple and Present Continuous

Here's a **comparative table** between the **Present Simple** and the **Present Continuous**, highlighting their key differences in **use**, **structure**, and **examples**.

Aspect	Present Simple	Present Continuous
Main Use	Habitual actions, routines, and general facts.	Actions happening right now or around the current time.
Affirmative Structure	Subject + base verb (+s for he/she/it)	Subject + am/are/is + verb-ing
Affirmative Example	She works in a bank.	She is working late today.
Negative Structure	Subject + do/does not + base verb	Subject + am/are/is + not + verb-ing
Negative Example	They don't like coffee.	They are not drinking coffee.
Interrogative Structure	Do/Does + subject + base verb + ?	Am/Are/Is + subject + verb-ing + ?
Interrogative Example	Do you speak English?	Are you speaking English right now?
Key Words	Always, usually, often, sometimes, never, every day/week/year.	Now, at the moment, currently, today, this week.



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